Module 3: Container & Cargo Management — User Help Guide

End-User Operations Manual for Container Yard Supervisors, CFS/ICD Coordinators, VGM Desks & Cargo Planners

1. Module Overview & Operational Purpose

The **Container & Cargo Management** module provides unit-level control over every shipping container and cargo lot handled by your company. It tracks ISO container numbers, equipment specifications, stuffing and terminal gate milestones, customs and carrier seal numbers, SOLAS Verified Gross Mass (VGM) compliance, temperature-controlled reefer settings, and IMDG Dangerous Goods declarations.

- **Who Uses This Module**: Container Fleet & Equipment Controllers, CFS/ICD Stuffing Supervisors, Export/Import Documentation Desks, and Dangerous Goods / Cold-Chain Compliance Officers.
- **How to Open**: Click **4. Container & Cargo** in the left sidebar navigation, or click any unit in the Dashboard's **Container & Customs Watchlist**.
- **Direct Shipment Linking**: Every container unit links directly to a **Shipment Reference** (Module 1) and **Booking Reference** (Module 2), allowing multiple containers (e.g., 2×40HQ or 5×20FT) to be attached to a single shipment.

2. Searching & Monitoring Container Units (Left Panel)

The left-hand equipment list displays all active and historical containers with real-time status badges:

- **Equipment Search**: Search by 11-character ISO Container Number (e.g., *MSCU8492016*), Seal Number, Shipment Reference, Booking Reference, Cargo Description, or Port.
- **Equipment Type & Status Filters**: Filter the list across all 8 container types (*20 FT Standard, 40 FT Standard, 40 FT High Cube, 20 FT Reefer, 40 FT Reefer, Open Top, Flat Rack, Tank Container*) and 10 lifecycle statuses (*Empty, Available, Booked, Stuffing, Loaded, In Transit, Arrived, Customs Hold, Delivered, Returned*).
- **Sorting & Actions**: Sort by Latest Updated Timestamp, Container Number, Gross Weight (High to Low), or Status. Click the **View** (eye) icon to generate a printable **SOLAS VGM & Container Equipment Certificate**.

3. Complete Field Reference Guide (Right Panel — Sections A to D)

The right-hand form captures equipment identification, commodity details, terminal operations, and live tracking across four sections.

Form Section	Key Fields Included	Operational Guidance & What to Enter
A. Container Identification	Container Record ID (Auto), Container Number*, Container Type*, ISO Code, Container Owner, Shipping Line, Booking Ref*, Shipment Ref*	Enter the 11-character ISO 6346 **Container Number** (4 owner letters + 7 digits). When you choose a **Container Type**, the system automatically fills the standard **ISO Code** (such as *22G1, 42G1, 45G1, 22R1, 45R1, 42U1, 42P3,* or *22K2*). Selecting a **Shipment Ref** automatically fills the Booking Ref, Shipping Line, Loading Port, and Discharge Port.
B. Cargo Details & DG / Reefer Specs	Cargo Name*, Cargo Description*, Category, HS Code, Package Type, No. of Packages*, Gross Weight (KG)*, Net Weight (KG), Volume (CBM)*, Declared Value, Currency, Dangerous Goods, UN Number, IMO Hazard Class, Temperature Req., Special Handling	Enter the commodity name, detailed packing marks, 6-to-8 digit **HS Code**, package count, and weights. As soon as you enter **Gross Weight (KG)**, the system automatically estimates the **SOLAS VGM Weight** in Section C by adding the container's tare weight. For hazardous cargo, set **Dangerous Goods** to *Yes* and enter the **UN Number** (e.g., *UN 1263*) and **IMO Hazard Class**. For reefers, specify the exact temperature range (e.g., *+2°C to +8°C*).
C. Terminal, Seal, VGM & Customs Ops	Loading Port*, Discharge Port*, Stuffing Location, De-stuffing Location, Loading/Unloading Dates, Gate-In/Gate-Out Dates, Seal Number*, VGM Weight (KG), Inspection Status, Customs Status	Record where the box was stuffed (e.g., *Factory Stuffed* or *JNPT Speedy CFS*), terminal Gate-In and vessel loading dates, the high-security bolt **Seal Number**, certified **Verified Gross Mass (VGM)**, CSC survey inspection status, and customs status (e.g., *LEO Issued / Cleared, Pending Assessment, Under Dock Examination, Customs Hold*).
D. Live Equipment Tracking	Container Status*, Current Reported Location*, Last Updated Timestamp (Auto)	Update the current operational stage (from *Empty* through *In Transit* and *Returned*) and type the latest reported position (e.g., *BMCT Terminal Yard Block C4* or *Passing Suez Canal Northbound*).

4. Step-by-Step Daily Workflows

1. **Logging a New Container Linked to a Shipment**: Click **New** in the left panel. In Section A, select the **Shipment Reference** from the dropdown list — the Booking Reference, Shipping Line, Loading Port, and Discharge Port fill in automatically. Enter the Container Number, select the Container Type, fill in Cargo Weight and Volume in Section B, enter the Seal Number in Section C, and click **Save Container**.
2. **Verifying SOLAS VGM & Printing the VGM Certificate**: When you type the Cargo Gross Weight in Section B, Section C automatically calculates the total VGM (Cargo Gross Weight + Standard Tare Weight for that equipment size). You can also type the exact weighbridge VGM figure directly into

the **Verified Gross Mass (VGM KG)** box. Click the **View** (eye) icon in the left table to print the official VGM & Equipment Certificate.

3. **Managing Hazardous (IMDG) & Cold-Chain Reefer Units**: Set **Dangerous Goods (IMDG)** to *Yes* to unlock the UN Number and Hazard Class fields. Any container flagged as Dangerous Goods is automatically highlighted with a red IMDG badge on the main Executive Dashboard Watchlist.

5. Best Practices & Troubleshooting Tips

Common Scenario / Question	Recommended Action in Container & Cargo Management
How is the automatic VGM estimate calculated?	The system adds standard ISO tare weights to your Cargo Gross Weight (e.g., +2,250 KG for 20 FT Standard, +3,980 KG for 40 FT High Cube, +5,200 KG for Flat Rack). Always overwrite with the actual certified weighbridge ticket weight if different.
Tracking multiple containers under one Bill of Lading	Create a separate container record for each physical box and assign them all the same **Shipment Reference** in Section A. All linked boxes will appear together on the Shipment's Bill of Lading Manifest.